

Bluesky, Twitter's offshoot, releases its initial code

The open source spinoff of Twitter, Bluesky, has released early code for a decentralised social network protocol. The technology is known as the Authenticated Data Experiment (or ADX) and is accessible for developers to test on GitHub, though Bluesky notes that it is still in its early stages. Since the project's conception in 2019 and its incorporation in early 2022, it's been one of the most significant windows into Bluesky's operations.

According to Bluesky CEO Jay Graber, ADX will be the beginning of a semi-public development process. "We're going to follow a middle route," Graber added, "publishing stuff before it's finished while also giving ourselves time to brainstorm new paths early on." A description of ADX's goals and design, as well as some experimental code, is available on GitHub. "Have fun with it, but don't use it to construct your next major social app just yet. Things are missing, and things will change," said Graber. The code is released under the MIT License, which makes it open source.



ADX isn't a singular, self-contained social network. It's a protocol that allows social network developers to implement user-controlled 'Personal Data Repositories'. It's designed to allow users to transfer social media posts between networks without compromising the networks' own moderating tools, among other things.

Bluesky has joined a sector that already includes various decentralised networking protocols, such as ActivityPub, which is used to power the Mastodon platform.

Microsoft's 3D Movie Maker is now open source

Microsoft has released a number of open source tools over the years, and now it has made its 3D Movie Maker available to everyone. 3D Movie Maker, which was first launched in 1995, allows you to create animated scenarios with 3D characters, props, backgrounds, text, sound, and special effects. This version also includes an Argonaut software build of BRender. While this is a positive step, you shouldn't get too enthusiastic because there is a catch. The project is unlikely to build successfully under modern hardware/software, but you can get started with compilation and get partial completed binaries.



The code was recovered from the Microsoft corporate archives, third-party authorisation (for products like BRender) was gained, and developer identities and aliases were deleted in order to make the software open source (with the exception of current Microsoft employees who worked on the original release and agreed to keep their names in place). It can be downloaded from GitHub.

IaSQL is open source and available as SaaS

IaSQL, the firm behind a service that uses SQL to model AWS infrastructure, has announced that IaSQL is now open source and available as software as a service. IaSQL provides a two-way connection between an AWS account and a hosted PostgreSQL database to describe an AWS deployment by mapping cloud APIs into SQL tables.

Co-founder and CEO LuisFer De Pombo explained: "Infrastructure as Code solutions do not have a good way of encoding dependencies across infrastructure pieces in a microservices architecture, which makes it really hard to make and revert changes to infrastructure. Representing your infrastructure as SQL resolves the primary issue of YAML-based infrastructure tools by making the relations between pieces of your infrastructure first-class citizens."

The service may be configured to manage existing deployments by connecting an AWS account to an IaSQL instance, populating the database with operating cloud resources, and defining and limiting services using a module system that maps every IaSQL module to an AWS service, such as aws ec2 or aws elb.

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